

Finding Evidence

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

A community center claims its new Saturday hours improve access for working adults. Forty-six percent of Saturday visitors reported that they could not attend weekday daytime programs.

Task: Which detail best supports the claim?

- A. The center has a front desk.
- B. Forty-six percent of Saturday visitors could not attend weekday daytime programs.
- C. Saturday comes after Friday.
- D. The center offers several programs.

Exercise 2

A manager says a new checklist reduced packing mistakes. Error logs fell from 31 errors in April to 18 in May after the checklist was introduced.

Task: Which detail is the strongest evidence?

- A. The checklist is one page long.
- B. The manager likes checklists.
- C. Errors fell from 31 to 18 after introduction.
- D. April and May are consecutive months.

Exercise 3

A school proposes adding a covered bicycle rack because students avoid cycling when rain is expected.

Task: Which additional evidence would most directly support the claim?

- A. A count of bicycles on rainy and dry school days.
- B. The color of current bicycle racks.
- C. The number of classrooms on campus.
- D. A history of bicycle design.

Exercise 4

A report says a reminder message may reduce missed appointments.

Task: Which detail would be LEAST useful evidence?

- A. Missed appointments before and after reminders began.
- B. The percentage of clients who received the reminder.
- C. A client comment saying the reminder helped them remember.
- D. The paint color in the waiting room.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. Forty-six percent of Saturday visitors could not attend weekday daytime programs.

Why: It directly shows that Saturday service reaches people blocked by weekday daytime schedules.

Exercise 2

Best answer: C. Errors fell from 31 to 18 after introduction.

Why: It directly measures the outcome named in the claim.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. A count of bicycles on rainy and dry school days.

Why: It tests whether rainy conditions are associated with lower bicycle use.

Exercise 4

Best answer: D. The paint color in the waiting room.

Why: It has no meaningful connection to whether reminders affect attendance.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.